

Eli Cochrane

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EDUCATION

University of Kansas – Lawrence, KS

B.A., Psychology & Political Science | B.S., Data Science

Expected May 2027

Cumulative GPA: 4.0/4.0

Honors: University Honors, University Scholar, Phi Kappa Phi, Psi Chi

Certificates: Mind and Brain Studies

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Social psychology, political psychology, identity and group dynamics, computational linguistics, natural language processing, social media discourse, collective identity narratives, data science

PUBLICATIONS & MANUSCRIPTS

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (2026). *Conspiracy Theories as Intelligence Performance: The Role of Audience and Need for Uniqueness*. [Manuscript in Preparation].

- Designed and administered a preregistered 2x2 between-subjects experiment examining whether public audience context amplifies conspiracism in language.
- Developed a multi-method computational natural language processing pipeline integrating corpus-based semantic similarity, LLM-based conspiracism ratings, and LIWC-22 psycholinguistic profiling.
- Identified significant condition interactions and individual difference moderator effects predicting whether conspiracy theories demonstrate intelligence in public settings.
- Supported by an Undergraduate Research Award from the University of Kansas.

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (2026). *Masculinity, Meaning, and Misogyny: Linguistic Markers of Intra- and Intergroup Identity Threat in r/JordanPeterson*. [Manuscript in Preparation].

- Analyzed 209,500 Reddit posts from 2017-2024, examining identity threat, group-based identity processes, language choice, and political polarization in online communities, focusing on how the source of identity threat predicts linguistic behavioral responses.
- Implemented dictionary-based analysis (LIWC-22), topic modeling (BERTopic), sentiment analysis (VADER), and latent profile analysis (TidyLPA) to quantify online political identity trends.
- Supported by an Undergraduate Research Award from the University of Kansas.

Cochrane, E. & Haider-Markel, D. (2026). LGBTQ+ Interest Groups. In *The SAGE Encyclopedia of Interest Groups and Lobbying*. [In Review].

- Invited to collaborate on a review article made for SAGE Publications Inc.'s Encyclopedia of Interest Groups and Lobbying.
- Reviewed and synthesized the history of and literature on interest groups and lobbying efforts focused on the advancement of LGBTQ+ civic rights in America.
- Supported by two Allan J. Cigler Political Science Academic Enrichment Awards.

RESEARCH PRESENTATIONS

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (Forthcoming July 2026). *Masculinity, Meaning, and Misogyny: Linguistic Markers of Intra- and Intergroup Identity Threat in r/JordanPeterson*. Parallel talk at the International Conference on Computational Social Science, Burlington, VT.

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (April 2026). *Masculinity in Community: Analyzing Identity Construction Discourse in r/JordanPeterson*. Poster presentation at the University of Kansas's Symposium for Undergraduate Psychology Engagement & Research, Lawrence, KS.

- Received a Best Independent Research Project Award.

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (April 2026). *Savviness Signaling and the Public Inflation of Conspiracy Beliefs*. Oral presentation at the Spring Undergraduate Research Symposium, University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

- Received a Best in Panel Award.

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (April 2026). *Savviness Signaling and the Hedged Expression of Conspiracy Beliefs*. Oral presentation at the Student Research Conference in the Psychological Sciences, Kansas City Kansas Community College, Kansas City, KS.

Cochrane, E. & Landau, M. (Feb. 2026). *Masculinity in Community: Analyzing Identity Construction Discourse in r/JordanPeterson*. Poster presentation at the annual meeting of the Society for Personality and Social Psychology (SPSP), Chicago, IL.

- Received SPSP's Undergraduate Student Poster Award.

Cochrane, E. & Forth, C. (April 2025). *Masculinity, Meaning, and Modernity: An Investigation into Jordan B. Peterson's Appeal to Male Ontological Insecurity*. Oral presentation at the Spring Undergraduate Research Symposium, University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

- Received an Outstanding Presentation Award.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

LEMMA Lab, University of Kansas

Aug. 2025 – Present

Principal Student Investigator | Mentor: Mark Landau, PhD, Social Psychology

- Led a study combining Qualtrics surveys and computational text analysis to explore self-presentation motivations and conspiracy belief expression.
- Led a study utilizing natural language processing techniques, including machine learning-based sentiment analysis and topic modeling, to identify patterns in identity construction in online masculinity-centered communities.
- Synthesizing social-psychological theories of group identity processes with inductive data insights to map discursive trends and their identity-building utility.

Political Science Department, University of Kansas

Aug. 2025 – Present

Principal Student Investigator | Mentor: Don Haider-Markel, PhD, Political Science

- Using LIWC-22 to map changes in language use among political elites for a collaborative book chapter on transgender rights in the media and political institutions.

- Developed Python scripts to scrape and structure all legislation and congressional transcripts from 2015-2025 to map changes in language use among political elites.
- Co-authored a SAGE encyclopedia entry on the historical development of LGBTQ+ interest groups, focusing on clear communication of existing research.
- Analyzed American National Election Survey data on public opinion toward LGBTQ+ rights and social issues as influenced by campaign strategies and political events.

Molina Lab, University of Kansas

Aug. 2025 – May 2026

Research Assistant | PI: Ludwin Molina, PhD, Social Psychology

- Executed semi-structured qualitative interviews to investigate Americans' perceptions of debt, economic inequality, and the American Dream.
- Conducted IRB-compliant interviews, ensuring data privacy and ethical practices while collecting high-quality data about participants' lived experiences.
- Synthesized interdisciplinary literature on neoliberalism and political psychology to inform interview protocol development and narrative coding schemes.

English Department, West Texas A&M University

June 2025 – Aug. 2025

Principal Student Investigator | Mentor: Bonnie Roos, PhD, English

- Conducted qualitative research on James Joyce's *Dubliners*, synthesizing close textual reading with psychological frameworks of colonial subjectivity and ontological security.
- Reviewed postcolonial theory and thematic analysis methods to develop a theoretical approach integrating coloniality, interpersonal relationships, and language choices.

Trade War Lab, University of Kansas

Dec. 2024 – May 2025

Research Assistant | PI: Jiakun Jack Zhang, PhD, Political Science

- Employed data-driven techniques to explore U.S.-China economic relations, analyzing trade policies, tariffs, and macroeconomic trends that affect international dynamics.
- Applied statistical methods in R and Python to interpret large tariff and economic activity datasets and identify key patterns in bilateral trade.

History Department, University of Kansas

June 2024 – May 2025

Principal Student Investigator | Mentor: Christopher Forth, PhD, History

- Conducted interdisciplinary political psychology research analyzing the intersection of historical masculinity norms, online discourse, and political radicalization.
- Synthesized existing research on hegemonic masculinity and ontological security to build a framework for future projects on identity and politicized masculinity.
- Developed an interest in NLP to efficiently process large-scale textual data, inspiring a research program focused on computational techniques for analyzing group identity.

HONORS & AWARDS

Academic Honors

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| • McCluskey-Fawcett Outstanding Honors Contribution Award | Spring 2026 |
| • Psi Chi Membership | Spring 2026 |
| • University Scholars | Spring 2026 |
| • Phi Kappa Phi Membership | Fall 2025 |
| • Phi Alpha Theta Membership | Spring 2025 |

- University of Kansas Dean's List (semesterly) Fall 2024 – Present
- KU Chancellor Merit Scholarship (semesterly) Fall 2024 – Present

Research Awards

- NSF-GRFP Application Workshop Fellowship Fall 2026
- KU Spring Symposium Best in Panel Award Spring 2026
- KU Psychology's Best Independent Research Project Award Spring 2026
- Portz Interdisciplinary Fellowship Campus Nomination Spring 2026
- SPSP Undergraduate Student Poster Award Spring 2026
- Allan J. Cigler Political Science Academic Enrichment Award – \$3,500 Spring 2026
- Alexandar Family Undergraduate Research Award – \$1,000 Spring 2026
- SPSP Diversity Undergraduate Registration Stipend Fall 2025
- KU Research Travel Award – \$500 Fall 2025
- Jack & Lavon Brosseau Honors Opportunity Award – \$1,500 Fall 2025
- Allan J. Cigler Political Science Academic Enrichment Award – \$2,000 Fall 2025
- Undergraduate Research Award – \$1,000 Summer 2025
- KU Spring Symposium Outstanding Research Presentation Award Spring 2025

Public Service Awards

- U.S.-Sino Leadership & Global Engagement Award Summer 2025

INVITED TALKS & SYMPOSIA

Cochrane, E. (Forthcoming in Sep. 2026). *Computational Linguistics Workshop*. Invited workshop at the professional seminar for the University of Kansas's Department of Linguistics, Lawrence, KS.

Cochrane, E. (Forthcoming in Aug. 2026). *Address to First-Year KU Honors Students*. Invited talk at the 2026 Honors Program Convocation, Lawrence, KS.

Cochrane, E. (July 2026). *Political Polarization and Discourse*. Invited chaired symposium at the 16th International Conference on Computational Social Science, Burlington, VT.

Cochrane, E. (Feb. 2025). *Artificial Intelligence & Ethical Decision-Making*. Invited talk at KU Honors Common Cause Symposium & KU's Center for Service Learning's Educate & Act panel series, University of Kansas, Lawrence, KS.

VOLUNTEERING & SERVICE

Founder & Co-President, Kansas Research Collective Jan. 2026 – Present

- Founded a group for research-oriented undergraduate students at KU to connect with each other and share advice for publishing and presenting independent research projects.
- Building efforts to recruit students who are interested in research, no matter their previous experience or academic interests.
- Collaborating on the development of expansion plans, collaborations with campus organizations, and meeting schedules that benefit all members.

- Implementing peer-to-peer services and workshops with KU's Center for Undergraduate Research to enhance initiatives for research-based student outreach.

Common Cause Student Design Team, KU Honors

Aug. 2024 – Jan. 2025

- Developed an interdisciplinary project on AI ethics, exploring the intersection of technology and human rights.
- Worked with other students to develop a presentation demonstrating how artificial intelligence attempts to make ethical decisions.

TEACHING & MENTORING

Teaching Assistant, Social Psychology (PSYC 360)

Jan. 2026 – May 2026

- Partnered with faculty to refine course pedagogy, optimizing syllabus layout and topic selection to enhance undergraduate engagement.
- Worked with students to ensure feedback translates into meaningful course adjustments that facilitate their understanding of social psychology.
- Managed course logistics including Canvas administration and iClicker integration to streamline attendance tracking and assessment.

Common Cause Peer Mentor, KU Honors

Aug. 2025 – Jan. 2026

- Led discussions on UN Sustainable Development Goals to create actionable plans to meet sustainability goals in the local community.
- Working closely with honors psychology students to improve sustainability while supporting lifestyles that support wellbeing and positive mental health.

Seminar Assistant, KU Honors

Aug. 2025 – Dec. 2025

- Guided discussion for HNRS 190: Secrets of Conspiracy Theories to ensure students understood and engaged with class material.
- Mentored 10 first-year honors students navigating academic transition.
- Graded assignments and provided feedback on papers.
- Assisted students in creating a project for KU Honors' First-Year Seminar Symposium that effectively communicated conspiracy theory research.

SKILLS

Natural Language Processing: LIWC-22, BERTopic, VADER, TidyLPA, NLTK

Programming & Statistical Analysis: Python (pandas, numpy, scikit-learn, matplotlib), R (tidyverse, ggplot2, Quarto, dplyr), Excel (advanced functions, pivot tables, visualization)

Methodologies: Quantitative (survey design and deployment, statistical modeling, data wrangling), qualitative (interviewing, phenomenology, theory-driven thematic analysis)

Software & Tools: Microsoft Office, Google Workspace, Qualtrics, Git/ GitHub

Certifications: CITI Social & Behavioral Research Ethics

Languages: English (native), French (intermediate)